

Modern UEFI Troubleshooting:

Compiled Jan 2026 by FIT – Jami Francis

If there's no time to use Keys to get into UEFI or BIOS::

1. **Windows Fast Startup (The Keyboard Ignore Feature):** Windows 10 and 11 hybrid hibernation:
 - **The Fix:** Hold down the **Shift** key while clicking **Shut Down** in Windows, or click **Restart** instead (restarts bypass Fast Startup).
2. **The Windows RE Fail-Safe:** If a machine boots too fast to catch the key, force it into the firmware directly from Windows:
 - Go to **Settings > System > Recovery > Advanced Startup** and click **Restart Now**.
 - Once in the blue menu, navigate to: **Troubleshoot > Advanced Options > UEFI Firmware Settings** to reboot directly into the BIOS.

MFR.	TYPE	MODELS	BOOT MENU	BOOT ONCE	BIOS KEY	CHANGE PRIORITY
ACER			Esc, F12, F9		Del, F2	
ACER	netbook	AspireOne, Aspire Timeline	F12		F2	
ACER	netbook	Aspire v3, v5, v7	F12	The "F12 Boot Menu" must be enabled in BIOS. It is disabled by default.	F2	
APPLE		After 2006	Option			
ASROCK	desktop		F11		F2, Del	

MFR.	TYPE	MODELS	BOOT MENU	BOOT ONCE	BIOS KEY	CHANGE PRIORITY
ASUS	desktop		F8		F9	
ASUS	laptop		Esc		F9	
ASUS	laptop	R503C	F8		DEL	
ASUS	netbook	Eee PC 1025c	Esc		F2	Boot Tab, Boot Device Priority, 1st Boot Device, Removable Device, F10
COMPAQ		Presario	Esc, F9		F10	BIOS "Advanced Tab", Boot Order
DELL	desktop	Dimension, Inspiron, Latitude	F12	Select "USB Flash Drive"	F2	
DELL	desktop	Inspiron One 2020, 2305, 2320, 2330 AIO	F12	Select "USB Flash Drive"	F2	
DELL	laptop	Inspiron	F12	Select "USB Storage Device"	F2	Settings->General->Boot Sequence->"USB Storage Device", then up arrow, [Apply]--[Exit]
DELL	laptop	Precision	F12	Select "USB Storage Device" from boot menu	F12	
EMACHINES			F12		Tab, Del	

MFR.	TYPE	MODELS	BOOT MENU	BOOT ONCE	BIOS KEY	CHANGE PRIORITY
GIGABYTE / AORUS	component / desktop		F12		Del	
HP	generic		Esc, F9		Esc, F10, F1	
HP	desktop	Media Center	Esc		F10	BIOS "Advanced" tab, Boot Order, Move "USB Device" before "Hard Drive"
HP	desktop	Pavilion 23 All In One	Esc	Select boot media from the menu	F10	BIOS "Advanced" tab, Boot Order, Move "USB Device" before "Hard Drive". For non-UEFI media, disable secure boot and enable legacy support
HP	desktop	Pavilion g6 and g7	Esc		F10	BIOS "Advanced" tab, Boot Order, Move "USB Device" before "Hard Drive"
HP	desktop	Pavilion HPE PC, h8-1287c	Esc	Then F9 for "Boot Menu"	Esc, F10	Storage tab, Boot Order, Legacy Boot Sources
HP	desktop	Pavilion PC, p6 2317c	Esc	Then F9 for "Boot Menu"	Esc, F10	Storage tab, Boot Order, Legacy Boot Sources
HP	desktop	Pavilion PC, p7 1297cb	Esc	Then F9 for "Boot Menu"	Esc, F10	Storage tab, Boot Order, Legacy Boot Sources

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HP	desktop	TouchSmart 520 PC	Esc	Then F9 for "Boot Menu"	Esc	Storage tab, Boot Order, Legacy Boot Sources
HP	laptop	2000	Esc	Select "Patriot Memory" on the Boot Option Menu	Esc	
HP	notebook	Pavilion	Esc		F10	BIOS "Advanced" tab, Boot Order, Move "USB Device" before "Hard Drive"
HP	notebook	ENVY dv6 and dv7 PC	Esc	Then F9 for "Boot Menu"	Esc	F10 Storage tab, Boot Order, Legacy Boot Sources
INTEL			F10			
LENOVO	desktop		F12, F8, F10		F1, F2	
LENOVO	laptop		F12		F1, F2	See page bottom
LENOVO	laptop	IdeaPad P500	F12 or Fn + F11		F2	See page bottom
LENOVO	laptop	IdeaPad, Yoga	Novo Button	Press recessed Novo pinhole button while completely powered off	Novo Button	See page bottom

MFR.	TYPE	MODELS	BOOT MENU	BOOT ONCE	BIOS KEY	CHANGE PRIORITY
MICROSOFT	tablet / laptop	Surface	Vol Down (-) + Power	Hold Vol Down, press Power, release Vol Down at logo	Vol Up (+) + Power	See page bottom
MSI	component / desktop		F11		Del	
NEC	laptop		F5		F2	
PACKARD BELL	laptop		F8		F1, Del	
SAMSUNG	laptop		F12, Esc		F2	Boot Tab, Select "Boot Device Priority", Press Return, Up/Down to Highlight, F6/F5 to change priority
SAMSUNG	netbook	NC10	Esc		F2	Boot Tab, Select "Boot Device Priority", Press Return, Up/Down to Highlight, F6/F5 to change priority
SAMSUNG	ultrabook	Series 5 Ultra and Series 7 Chronos	Esc		F2	
SHARP					F2	
SONY		VAIO, PCG, VGN	F11		F1, F2, F3	

MFR.	TYPE	MODELS	BOOT MENU	BOOT ONCE	BIOS KEY	CHANGE PRIORITY
SONY		VGN Esc	F10		F2	BIOS "BOOT" section, "External Device Boot" enabled
TOSHIBA		Protege, Satellite, Tecra	F12		F1, Esc	
TOSHIBA		Equium F12	F12		F12	

Specific Modern Device Quirks

- **Microsoft Surface (Tablets/Laptops):**
 - *BIOS/UEFI Setup:* Press and hold the **Volume Up (+)** button, then press and release the **Power** button. Release Volume Up when the Surface logo appears.
 - *Boot from USB:* Press and hold the **Volume Down (-)** button, then press and release the **Power** button. Release Volume Down when the logo appears.
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- **Lenovo Laptops (The "Novo" Button):**
 - Many modern Lenovo IdeaPads and Yoga laptops feature a tiny, recessed pinhole button on the side or bottom marked with a curved arrow icon (the Novo button). Pressing this with a paperclip while the machine is completely powered off is often the *only* way to trigger the "Novo Button Menu," which gives direct access to BIOS Setup or the Boot Menu.